

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2018

Round 2 Problem 1 Hark the Heraldry Angels Sing

Heraldry is the study of rank and heraldic arms, and there is a part which looks particularly at the way that coats-of-arms and shields are put together. The language for describing arms is known as blazon and derives many of its terms from French. The aim of blazon is to describe heraldic arms unambiguously and as concisely as possible.

On the next page are some blazon descriptions that correspond to the shields (escutcheons) A-L. However, the descriptions and the shields are not in the same order.

1. Quarterly 1 & 4 checky vert and argent 2 & 3 argent three gouttes gules two one
2. Azure a bend sinister argent in dexter chief four roundels sable
3. Per pale azure and gules on a chevron sable four roses argent a chief or
4. Per fess checky or and sable and azure overall a roundel counterchanged a bordure gules
5. Per chevron azure and vert overall a lozenge counterchanged in sinister chief a rose or
6. Quarterly azure and gules overall an escutcheon checky sable and argent
7. Vert on a fess sable three lozenges argent
8. Gules three annulets or one two impaling sable on a fess indented azure a rose argent
9. Argent a bend embattled between two lozenges sable
10. Per bend or and argent in sinister chief a cross crosslet sable
11. Gules a cross argent between four cross crosslets or on a chief sable three roses argent
12. Or three chevrons gules impaling or a cross gules on a bordure sable gouttes or

On your answer sheet:

(a) Match up the escutcheons A-L with their blazon descriptions.

(b) Write the blazon descriptions of M and N.

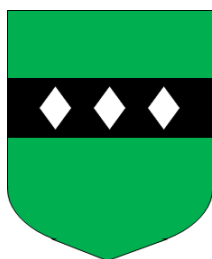
(c) Draw the escutcheons described by the following blazons:

1. Quarterly azure and or overall five roses sable three one one a bordure vert.
2. Per chevron sable and argent in sinister chief an annulet or in dexter chief a roundel vert.

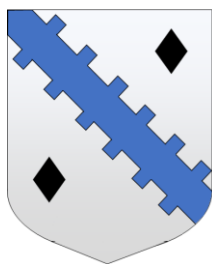
Your drawing isn't a test of artistic skills, but of how well you understand blazons, so don't worry about graphic quality. Your diagrams should indicate the colours of the various parts, but you're welcome to use any method you choose for showing colours, including coloured pens, annotation (with arrows) or any combination. If you are colour blind, please tell us on your answer sheet.

(d) Explain how the language of blazon works.

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A.



B.



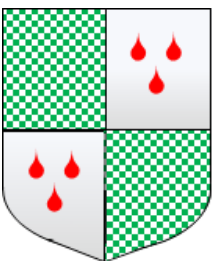
C.



D.



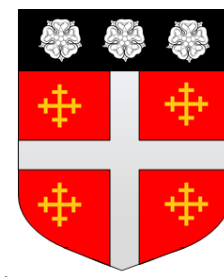
E.



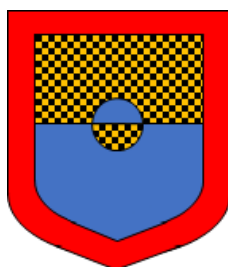
F.



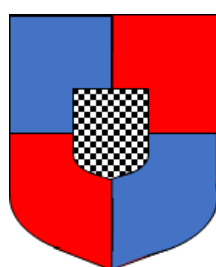
G.



H.



I.



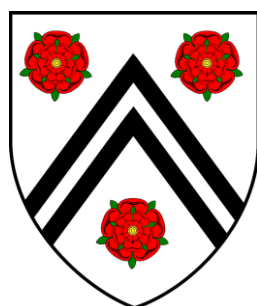
J.



K.



L.



M.



N.